

Word family: exhaust / exhausted / exhausting / exhaustion / exhaustive / exhaustively / exhaustible / inexhaustible

Base word: exhaust

Verb forms: exhaust, exhausts, exhausted, exhausting

Adjectives: exhausted, exhausting, exhaustive, exhaustible, inexhaustible

Nouns: exhaustion, exhaust

Adverb: exhaustively

Useful compounds: exhaust fumes, exhaust gas, exhaust pipe, exhaust system, exhaust fan, physical exhaustion, mental exhaustion, resource exhaustion

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your original sentence:

“...I often got home **feeling exhausted**.”

A full semantic sweep shows one very useful underlying concept:

something has been used, drained, or taken so far that little or nothing remains

This explains seemingly different meanings such as:

- a person being **exhausted** → energy almost completely used up;
- **exhausting** work → work that uses up your energy;
- **exhaust** a supply → use all of it;
- **exhaust** every possibility → consider/use every available possibility;
- vehicle **exhaust** → gases expelled from an engine;
- an **exhaustive** study → one that tries to cover everything, leaving nothing unexamined.

Meaning in your passage: exhausted = extremely tired — 筋疲力盡的; 疲憊不堪的

Your sentence:

"I often got home **feeling exhausted**."

Here, **exhausted** describes the speaker.

It means:

so physically and/or mentally tired that most of one's energy feels used up.

繁體中文：身心非常疲倦，精力幾乎耗盡；筋疲力盡的

Natural translation:

"I often got home feeling exhausted."

「我經常回到家時已經筋疲力盡／疲憊不堪。」

This is much stronger than simply:

tired = 累

1. **exhausted + person** (身體／精神) — 筋疲力盡的；疲憊不堪的

This is your exact original sense.

Practice 1 — Original

"I often got home **feeling exhausted**."

「我經常回到家時已經筋疲力盡。」

Practice 2

"She was completely **exhausted** after the long journey."

「長途旅程後，她已經疲憊不堪。」

Practice 3

"By the end of the week, everyone felt **exhausted**."

「到了星期末，每個人都感到筋疲力盡。」

exhausted — person = 體力或精神能量幾乎耗盡，以致極度疲倦

2. mentally/emotionally exhausted (精神／情緒) — 心力交瘁的；精神疲憊的

Exhausted is not limited to physical tiredness.

Practice 4

“After dealing with complaints all day, she felt mentally **exhausted**.”

「處理了一整天投訴後，她感到精神疲憊不堪。」

Practice 5

“The constant stress left him emotionally **exhausted**.”

「持續的壓力令他情緒上心力交瘁。」

mentally/emotionally exhausted = 精神或情緒能量被長時間壓力、思考或情緒負擔消耗殆盡

This belongs to the same “energy depleted” sense as physical exhaustion, so we should **not** treat it as a totally separate lexical meaning.

3. exhaust = make someone extremely tired (使人) — 使筋疲力盡；耗盡……精力

Now **exhaust** is a verb.

Practice 6

“The long commute **exhausted** me.”

「漫長的通勤令我筋疲力盡／耗盡我的精力。」

Practice 7

“Looking after three young children can **exhaust** anyone.”

「照顧三個年幼孩子可以令任何人都累得筋疲力盡。」

exhaust someone = 消耗某人的體力／精神能量, 令其極度疲倦

4. exhausting = causing extreme tiredness — 令人筋疲力盡的; 非常累人的

This is the critical contrast with **exhausted**.

Practice 8

“The journey was **exhausting**.”

「這趟旅程非常累人／令人筋疲力盡。」

Practice 9

“Commuting for three hours every day is **exhausting**.”

「每天通勤三小時非常令人疲累／累人。」

exhausting = 某件事情大量消耗人的體力或精神, 因此令人極度疲倦

Critical distinction: exhausted vs exhausting

This is essential.

exhausted

describes the **person/animal that experiences the tiredness**:

“I am exhausted.”

「我筋疲力盡。」

exhausting

describes the **thing/activity that causes the tiredness**:

“The commute is exhausting.”

「通勤令人筋疲力盡。」

So:

I was exhausted because the journey was exhausting.

「我筋疲力盡，因為那趟旅程非常累人。」

Exactly the same pattern as:

- bored / boring
 - interested / interesting
 - tired / tiring
 - stressed / stressful
-

5. exhaustion = extreme physical/mental tiredness — 筋疲力盡; 極度疲勞

The main noun.

Practice 10

“She collapsed from **exhaustion**.”

「她因為極度疲勞而倒下。」

Practice 11

“Weeks of poor sleep led to complete **exhaustion**.”

「數星期睡眠不足令她陷入筋疲力盡的狀態。」

exhaustion — person = 體力或精神能量被嚴重消耗後所形成的極度疲勞狀態

6. exhaust + supply/resource/money (資源) — 用盡; 耗盡

A major non-human meaning.

Practice 12

“The project **exhausted** most of our budget.”

「這個項目幾乎耗盡了我們的預算。」

Practice 13

“The village had **exhausted** its water supply.”

「村落已經用盡了供水儲備。」

exhaust a resource/supply = 使用某種有限資源, 直到幾乎或完全沒有剩餘

Common objects:

- exhaust a supply
 - exhaust resources
 - exhaust funds
 - exhaust reserves
 - exhaust available capacity
-

7. exhausted + resource/supply/reserves (資源) — 已耗盡的; 用完的

Here, **exhausted** does not mean “tired.”

Practice 14

“The emergency supplies were nearly **exhausted**.”

「緊急物資幾乎已經耗盡。」

Practice 15

“Once the battery is fully **exhausted**, it must be recharged.”

「電池的電量完全耗盡後，就需要重新充電。」

exhausted — resource = 有限資源已被使用到幾乎或完全沒有剩餘

So:

an exhausted passenger

= 筋疲力盡的乘客

exhausted supplies

= 已耗盡的物資

Same underlying concept, different Chinese translation.

8. **exhaustion** = depletion of a resource (資源耗盡) — 耗盡; 枯竭

The noun can also refer to resources.

Practice 16

“Overuse can lead to the **exhaustion of natural resources**.”

「過度使用可能導致天然資源耗盡／枯竭。」

Practice 17

“The researchers warned about groundwater **exhaustion**.”

「研究人員警告地下水可能出現枯竭／耗盡。」

exhaustion — resources = 某種有限供應被持續消耗至接近或完全用完的狀態

9. exhaust + possibilities/options/alternatives (可能性／選項) — 用盡；逐一試盡

A very important figurative/academic use.

Practice 18

“We have **exhausted all the available options.**”

「我們已經把所有可行選項都試盡／用盡了。」

Practice 19

“The police **exhausted every possible lead.**”

「警方徹底追查了所有可能的線索。」

exhaust possibilities/options = 把所有可用的方法、選擇或可能性逐一使用、嘗試或查證，直到沒有其他選項剩下

This is a major extension of:

use everything until nothing remains

10. exhaust + topic/subject/question (題目／議題) — 徹底討論；把內容說盡

Practice 20

“We cannot **exhaust** the subject in one lecture.”

「我們不可能在一堂課內把這個題目徹底講盡。」

Practice 21

“The report does not attempt to **exhaust** every aspect of the issue.”

「這份報告並不打算把問題的每一個層面都徹底論述完畢。」

exhaust a subject = 把某個議題能討論、分析或說明的內容幾乎全部涵蓋完

This is formal/academic.

11. **exhaust + legal/administrative remedies** (法律／行政途徑) — 用盡所有救濟／申訴途徑

A common legal expression worth retaining.

Practice 22

“Applicants must **exhaust all available remedies** before bringing the case to court.”

「申請人必須先用盡所有可用的救濟／申訴途徑，才可把案件提交法院。」

Practice 23

“She had **exhausted** the internal appeal process.”

「她已經用盡內部所有上訴程序。」

exhaust remedies/appeals = 把法律或行政制度提供的所有可行程序逐一使用完畢

This is legal/formal English, but common enough to be useful.

12. **exhaust = waste gas expelled by an engine** (名詞) — 廢氣；排氣

Now **exhaust** is a noun.

Practice 24

“The air smelled of car **exhaust**.”

「空氣中有汽車廢氣／排氣的氣味。」

Practice 25

“Vehicle **exhaust** contributes to air pollution.”

「車輛廢氣會造成空氣污染。」

exhaust — noun = 引擎燃燒燃料後排出的廢氣

Usually uncountable in this sense.

13. exhaust fumes / exhaust gases (車輛／機械) — 廢氣；排放氣體

A very common compound.

Practice 26

“Do not breathe in **exhaust fumes**.”

「不要吸入廢氣。」

Practice 27

“The tunnel was filled with **exhaust gases**.”

「隧道內充滿了引擎排放氣體。」

exhaust fumes/gases = 引擎、機械等在運作／燃燒後排出的氣體

14. exhaust system (車輛) — 排氣系統

Practice 28

“The mechanic inspected the **exhaust system**.”

「技師檢查了汽車的排氣系統。」

Practice 29

“A damaged exhaust system can make the car unusually loud.”

「受損的排氣系統可能令汽車異常嘈吵。」

exhaust system = 把引擎廢氣導出車外並協助控制噪音／排放的整套裝置

15. exhaust pipe (車輛) — 排氣管

Practice 30

“Smoke was coming from the **exhaust pipe**.”

「煙從排氣管冒出來。」

Practice 31

“The exhaust pipe needs replacing.”

「排氣管需要更換。」

exhaust pipe = 車輛／機械中把廢氣排出的管道

16. exhaust + air/gas (工程) — 排出；抽走

The verb also has a mechanical/technical meaning.

Practice 32

“The system **exhausts** hot air from the building.”

「系統把熱空氣從建築物內排出。」

Practice 33

“The fan **exhausts** fumes through the roof.”

「風扇把煙氣經屋頂抽走／排出。」

exhaust — engineering verb = 把空氣、氣體、煙霧等從一個封閉空間抽走並排到外面

This connects directly to the noun **exhaust**.

17. **exhaust fan** (設備) — 抽氣扇；排氣扇

A very useful household/building compound.

Practice 34

“Turn on the **exhaust fan** while cooking.”

「煮食時請開啟抽氣扇／排氣扇。」

Practice 35

“The bathroom needs a stronger **exhaust fan**.”

「浴室需要一部更強力的抽氣扇。」

exhaust fan = 把室內空氣、蒸氣、氣味或煙霧抽出並排到外面的風扇

18. **exhaustive** = **extremely thorough and complete** (研究／清單／搜索) — 詳盡的；全面徹底的

This is one of the most important family extensions.

And it is a classic learner trap:

exhaustive ≠ exhausting

Practice 36

“The report provides an **exhaustive analysis** of the problem.”

「這份報告對問題作出了全面而詳盡的分析。」

Practice 37

“The police carried out an **exhaustive search**.”

「警方進行了徹底而全面的搜索。」

exhaustive = 力求把所有相關部分、可能性或細節全部涵蓋，不留下重要遺漏的

Underlying idea:

exhaust all possibilities → cover everything

19. exhaustively = in a thorough and complete way — 詳盡地；徹底地

Practice 38

“The issue has been studied **exhaustively**.”

「這個問題已被非常詳盡地／徹底地研究。」

Practice 39

“The report examines each possibility **exhaustively**.”

「報告對每種可能性都作了全面而徹底的分析。」

exhaustively = 以幾乎涵蓋所有相關細節／可能性的方式

20. **exhaustible** = capable of being used up — 可耗盡的; 有限的

A useful academic/environmental adjective.

Practice 40

“Fossil fuels are **exhaustible resources**.”

「化石燃料屬於可耗盡的有限資源。」

Practice 41

“Fresh water is not an unlimited resource; in some contexts it is effectively **exhaustible**.”

「淡水並非無限資源; 在某些情況下, 它實際上是會被耗盡的。」

exhaustible = 數量有限, 因此可能因持續使用而被完全耗盡的

21. **inexhaustible** = impossible/seemingly impossible to use up — 取之不盡的; 源源不絕的

A very useful opposite family member.

Practice 42

“Solar energy is often described as an **inexhaustible** source of energy.”

「太陽能常被形容為取之不盡的能源。」

Practice 43

“She seems to have an **inexhaustible supply of energy**.”

「她似乎有源源不絕、用不完的精力。」

inexhaustible = 數量／能力似乎大到無法被完全用盡的

This may be literal or figurative:

- inexhaustible resource
 - inexhaustible patience
 - inexhaustible energy
 - inexhaustible curiosity
-

22. **exhaustive list/search/test**(全部涵蓋) — 完整無遺漏的; 全面的

This deserves a usage note because **exhaustive** often appears in academic/business writing.

Practice 44

“This is not intended to be an **exhaustive list**.”

「這份清單並非要做到完全涵蓋所有項目。」

Practice 45

“An **exhaustive** review of the evidence would take months.”

「若要對證據進行全面而不遺漏重要資料的審查, 可能需要數月。」

exhaustive = 試圖把同一範圍中的所有重要項目／可能性全部處理完

Critical distinction: exhausted vs exhausting vs exhaustive

These three look extremely similar but are very different.

exhausted

= person/resource has little energy/supply left

“I am exhausted.”

「我筋疲力盡。」

exhausting

= causes someone to become exhausted

“The commute is exhausting.”

「通勤非常累人。」

exhaustive

= extremely thorough/complete

“The report is exhaustive.”

「報告非常全面詳盡。」

So:

an exhausted student

= 筋疲力盡的學生

an exhausting exam

= 令人筋疲力盡的考試

an exhaustive study

= 全面詳盡的研究

This is one of the best MCQ contrasts in the family.

Important distinction: exhausted vs tired

tired

= lacking some energy; needing rest.

exhausted

= extremely tired; energy feels nearly used up.

Compare:

“I’m tired.”

「我累了。」

“I’m exhausted.”

「我累得筋疲力盡了。」

So **exhausted** is substantially stronger.

Important distinction: exhausted vs sleepy

exhausted

= severely lacking physical/mental energy.

sleepy

= feeling that you want to sleep.

You can be:

exhausted but unable to sleep

or:

sleepy without being exhausted.

Chinese:

- exhausted = 精疲力竭
 - sleepy = 睏／想睡
-

Important distinction: exhausted vs drained

exhausted

= very tired, physical or mental.

drained

= energy/emotional resources feel emptied, especially psychologically.

“I felt emotionally drained.”

「我感到情緒能量被掏空。」

They overlap strongly, but **drained** often emphasizes a feeling of emotional emptiness.

Important distinction: exhausting vs tiring

tiring

= causes tiredness.

exhausting

= causes **very severe** tiredness.

“The walk was tiring.”

「這趟步行很累人。」

“The twelve-hour hike was exhausting.”

「十二小時的遠足令人筋疲力盡。」

Exhausting is stronger.

Important distinction: exhaust vs use

use

= consume some amount.

exhaust

= use **all or nearly all** of what is available.

“We used some of our budget.”

「我們用了部分預算。」

“We exhausted our budget.”

「我們把預算耗盡了。」

The “completeness” component is crucial.

Important distinction: exhaust vs deplete

These overlap strongly with resources.

exhaust

= use completely/all available supply.

deplete

= significantly reduce the amount, not necessarily all the way to zero.

“The reserves were depleted.”

「儲備大幅減少。」

“The reserves were exhausted.”

「儲備已經耗盡。」

So **exhaust** is usually stronger and more complete.

Important distinction: exhaust vs consume

consume

= use up resources as part of a process.

exhaust

= reach the point where the resource is gone/nearly gone.

“The device consumes a lot of power.”

「裝置耗用很多電力。」

“Continuous use exhausted the battery.”

「持續使用把電池電量耗盡了。」

Important distinction: exhaust vs discuss thoroughly

For a subject:

“We discussed the issue thoroughly.”

= 我們詳細討論了這個問題。

“We exhausted the subject.”

= 我們幾乎把這個題目所有能談的內容都談盡了。

Exhaust emphasizes nothing significant remains to be covered.

Important distinction: exhaust vs emissions

exhaust

= gases expelled by an engine / sometimes the system carrying them away.

emissions

= substances released into the environment, broader category.

Vehicle exhaust is a type of emission.

But emissions can include:

- factory emissions;
- carbon emissions;
- methane emissions.

So:

exhaust $\subset$ **emissions** in many environmental contexts.

Important distinction: exhaust fumes vs smoke

exhaust fumes

= gases produced and expelled by engines.

smoke

= visible airborne particles/gases produced by burning.

Car exhaust may sometimes be visibly smoky, but **exhaust fumes** and **smoke** are not identical.

Important distinction: exhaust fan vs fan

fan

= moves air.

exhaust fan

= specifically removes air/fumes/moisture from a space and sends them outside.

So a desk fan circulates air; an exhaust fan extracts it.

Important distinction: exhaustive vs comprehensive

These overlap.

comprehensive

= covering many/all important aspects broadly.

exhaustive

= attempting to leave essentially nothing relevant unexamined.

comprehensive guide

= 全面指南

exhaustive analysis

= 極其詳盡、力求不遺漏任何相關部分的分析

Exhaustive usually sounds stronger.

Important distinction: exhaustive vs exhausting

This spelling trap deserves repeating:

an exhaustive meeting

would normally mean a meeting that covers the subject extremely thoroughly.

an exhausting meeting

means the meeting makes you extremely tired.

One letter changes the meaning dramatically.

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

- **exhaust someone** = 使某人筋疲力盡
- **exhausted — person** = 筋疲力盡的
- **exhausted — mental/emotional** = 心力交瘁的
- **exhausting** = 令人筋疲力盡的
- **exhaustion — person** = 極度疲勞
- **exhaust resources/supplies** = 耗盡資源／物資
- **exhausted resources** = 已耗盡的資源
- **resource exhaustion** = 資源耗竭
- **exhaust possibilities/options** = 把所有可能性／選項逐一用盡
- **exhaust a subject** = 把議題徹底說盡／討論完
- **exhaust legal remedies** = 用盡法律／行政救濟途徑
- **exhaust — noun** = 引擎廢氣／排氣
- **exhaust fumes/gases** = 排放廢氣
- **exhaust system** = 排氣系統
- **exhaust pipe** = 排氣管
- **exhaust air/fumes — verb** = 抽走／排出空氣或氣體
- **exhaust fan** = 抽氣扇／排氣扇
- **exhaustive** = 全面詳盡、力求不遺漏的
- **exhaustively** = 詳盡地／徹底地
- **exhaustible** = 可被耗盡的
- **inexhaustible** = 取之不盡／源源不絕的

This is a strong example of why the Family Sweep matters: **exhaustive** is easy to overlook if we only look at obvious inflections, but it is one of the most useful modern relatives in the entire family.

Master comparison

Form / sense

MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning

exhausted — person

體力或精神能量幾乎耗盡，因而極度疲倦的

mentally/emotionally exhausted	因長時間思考、壓力或情緒負擔而心力交瘁的
exhaust someone	大量消耗某人的體力／精神，使其極度疲倦
exhausting	大量消耗人的體力或精神，因此令人筋疲力盡的
exhaustion — person	體力或精神能量嚴重消耗後形成的極度疲勞狀態
exhaust a resource/supply	把有限資源持續使用到幾乎或完全沒有剩餘
exhausted resource/supply	已被使用到幾乎或完全沒有剩餘的
resource exhaustion	有限資源因持續消耗而接近或完全用盡的狀態
exhaust possibilities/options	把所有可用方法、選擇或可能性逐一使用／嘗試完畢
exhaust a subject	把某個議題可討論／分析的重要內容幾乎全部涵蓋完
exhaust remedies	把法律／行政制度提供的所有可行程序逐一使用完畢
exhaust — noun	引擎燃燒燃料後排出的廢氣
exhaust fumes/gases	車輛／機械運作後排出的氣體
exhaust system	將引擎廢氣導出並控制排放／噪音的裝置系統
exhaust pipe	將車輛／機械廢氣排出的管道
exhaust air/fumes — verb	把空氣、煙霧或氣體從封閉空間抽走並排出
exhaust fan	專門把室內空氣、煙霧、蒸氣或氣味抽走的風扇
exhaustive	力求把所有相關部分、細節或可能性都涵蓋而不留下重要遺漏的
exhaustively	以全面而徹底、幾乎不遺漏相關內容的方式
exhaustible	數量有限，因此可因持續使用而被完全耗盡的
inexhaustible	數量／能力似乎無法被完全用盡；取之不盡的

For your original sentence

“...I often got home **feeling exhausted**.”

The exact meaning is:

exhausted = 因每天通勤、嘈雜和擠迫等因素消耗大量體力／精神後，感到能量幾乎耗盡、極度疲倦

Natural translation:

「我經常回到家時已經筋疲力盡。」

And the four forms most worth locking together are:

exhaust someone → 使某人筋疲力盡

exhausted person → 感到筋疲力盡的人

exhausting experience → 令人筋疲力盡的經歷

exhaustion → 筋疲力盡／極度疲勞

plus the easily missed but extremely useful:

exhaustive analysis → 全面而詳盡、力求不遺漏的分析

That **exhausting vs exhaustive** contrast is particularly strong MCQ material.